

at the cinema and less likely to search for it on the internet? Consider how the film was **marketed** more traditionally (poster campaign, trailer in cinemas etc.) as well as online.

- The film was **exhibited** at various film festivals and received a **theatrical release** in Britain and various other countries (including France, Spain, Brazil and Japan – although not in the USA). It was later released on **digital download** and **DVD/Blu-ray**.

Consider the effect of individual producers on media industries:

- It may be useful to explore Ken Loach and his significance as a practitioner in British and Global cinema - how Loach has been able to repeatedly secure **funding** for social realist films and the extent to which the **genre** itself exists in its current form due to his work.
- Consider the extent to which *I, Daniel Blake* can be described as a **mainstream** product. Loach is a well-known and successful figure in the UK and Europe but is his work mainstream? Does the fact he is challenging governmental policy mean he is also challenging mainstream opinions?
- It might also be interesting to consider whether there exists a pre-sold **audience** of Loach fans who are eager to watch his films and the extent to which this gives him license to make films that might not otherwise secure finance.

Consider how media organisations maintain, including through marketing, varieties of audiences nationally and globally:

- The **marketing** materials establish the status and reputation of film – positive critical comments on the poster, reference to the Palme d'Or award in the trailer etc.
- The **genre** (British social realist film) and **director** Ken Loach are important factors in maintaining an audience. Loach has a long history of directing work in the genre (*Kes* from

1969 might be a useful specific comparison) and, unlike some film genres which have been impacted by technical developments and special effects, might this genre be particular in its tendency to resist change?

- There are specific and distinct **potential audiences** that the film is attempting to target through its **marketing**:
 - » The trailer references the BBC, BFI and the Palme d'Or. Discuss the extent to which these references suggest an assumed education and level of media literacy in the **target audience**.
 - » The **trailer** explores specific governmental policy which also may suggest audiences will have an awareness of political and social issues in the UK.
 - » The only specific “star” identified in the trailer using intertitles is the **director** Ken Loach. Loach’s work whilst having broad appeal sits firmly within the niche of social realism and candidates may discuss the extent to which the fans of his work are pre-sold based on his name alone.

Consider theoretical perspectives:

Power and media industries – Curran and Seaton

- Consider the extent to which the trailer is a **challenge** to ideas set out by Curran and Seaton.
 - » The trailer seems to offer an experience that sits outside the logic of **profit and power** and may arguably also demonstrate a level of variety and creativity that does not reflect Curran and Seaton’s ideas about the impact of media concentration.
 - » Candidates might also consider whether the trailer is able to offer a more adventurous production due to socially diverse patterns of **ownership** or (as above) Loach’s own pre-sold **audience**.